Japan Portfolio Brief — Monday, November 9, 2026

Covers Fri Nov 6 US session, the weekend, and the Mon Nov 9 Tokyo and Seoul sessions (both closed). **Data-quality warning (continuing):** research ran on search snippets only. kabutan, TDnet, DART, MOF, BoJ, CNBC, investinglive and sedaily pages could not be fetched, so no primary document was opened. "QUIET/UNVERIFIED" means "nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are mostly aggregator-sourced. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call. No per-stock closes were found for Nov 6 or Nov 9 for most holdings.

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1. Top of the stack

1. Relief bounce, not a recovery: Nikkei +2.33% to 58,775.50, Topix +2.97% to 3,818.16; KOSPI -0.81% to 5,018.85. The Nikkei opened strongly (morning close 59,411.34, +3.44%) and faded on afternoon profit-taking (rallies.ai, BigGo; the CNBC live blog carrying the same close is dated Nov 8, so the date label is suspect, but the arithmetic ties to Friday's 57,434.77 and 3,707.99). The Nikkei remains more than 20% below its June record. The driver was Friday's US tech rebound (Nasdaq +1.09%, AMD +11%, Nvidia +2.8%) after Thursday's -5.5% (TechFlow, investinglive). KOSPI rose as much as +2.24% intraday (5,172.94) and gave all of it back, closing 5,018.85 (Seoul Economic Daily, Korea Times; AJP has 5,021.97, -0.75%). Foreigners sold again (₩658bn per Korea Times, ₩865bn per AJP, unreconciled); KOSDAQ 639 (-0.8%) saw Alteogen -16%, EcoPro -8.5% (Newspim). KOSPI is down about 11% on the week and roughly 25% from July. Context: Friday Nov 6 was Nikkei -5.96% to 57,434.77 and KOSPI -6.02% to 5,059.69 (NHK, sedaily). MATTERS: the AI-beta regime is unresolved; Korea did not join the bounce.

2. SoftBank Group (9984): H1 results due Tue Nov 10, into the ABB Robotics block and credit worries. China blocked the $5.375bn ABB Robotics deal on Nov 5 (Nikkei Asia). One unopened Korean-language summary has the stock closing Nov 9 at ¥3,400 (-4.2%) on ABB doubts and rising CDS premiums (JKN); this is UNVERIFIED and the price level looks inconsistent with the stock's 2026 range, so do not rely on it (it would also run against the market's +2.3%). Results date per tousaiblog (secondary). MATTERS: the largest single-name event this week; watch OpenAI marks, leverage and the ABB write-down/termination language.

3. LG Chem (051915 pref): Q3 operating profit ₩561.2bn; the earlier conflicting ₩901.2bn figure is likely a stale 2022 number. Q3 revenue ₩15.496tn (+34% y/y), operating profit -17.4% y/y, petrochemicals lost ₩175.6bn, net loss about ₩600bn, and ex-LGES the group is effectively loss-making (iNews24, Korea Center). The ₩901.2bn/₩14.18tn print in the Munhwa piece matches Q3 2022 on surrounding numbers (our inference; the article does not state the year), so we treat ₩561.2bn as correct. LGES PRS sale (6,535,939 shares, about ₩2.5tn, 2-year, reference price ₩382,500): proceeds Nov 27, stake falls from 79.38% to about 76.6%, about ₩400bn to returns, with a roughly 6-month trust buyback covering common and preferred; reports conflict on the buyback/dividend split (Newdaily, JoongAng). MATTERS.

4. NAVER (035420): Nvidia's ₩1.34tn subscription fully paid; Q3 around Nov 11. Nvidia paid ₩1.3412tn for 6,558,435 new shares (about 4.13%, third-largest holder) on Nov 6 per the DART filing; new shares list Nov 27 (CEO Score Daily, SBS Biz). Q3 listed Wed Nov 11, 16:00 KST, consensus revenue about ₩3.54tn (knowingasset; unconfirmed by the company). Weak Q3 and cost concerns cited for share-price softness. MATTERS.

5. Macro: BoJ December hike odds high; USD/JPY near 158.5 with intervention line at 160; BoK hike in play. See Section 2. Also note a new headline risk: Nvidia's board opened an independent probe into Jensen Huang over a relationship with an executive at Megaspeed (TechFlow); Asia largely shrugged it off.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** policy rate reported at 1.25% (carried forward, not confirmed from the BoJ). December meeting is Dec 17 or 18 (unconfirmed). Hike odds conflict: 68.4% as of about Nov 6 (tradingnews) versus other snippets at 54–80%. Ueda reportedly said the BoJ will "weigh the pros and cons" of adjusting rates (undated, unsourced).
- **JGBs:** no Nov 9 yields found. Nov 2: 10y 2.77%, 20y 3.63%, 30y 3.875% (rallies.ai). An undated Zawya piece has the rout pulling 10y to 2.61%, 20y 3.51%, 30y 3.805%. A 30y auction is Nov 10 and a 5y auction Nov 12 (rallies.ai preview, not MOF). The last 30y auction (Oct 8) is shown at 4.109% (investing.com), inconsistent with a ~3.8% market level; unresolved. No 2y/5y levels found.
- **Yen:** USD/JPY about 158.44–158.53 on Nov 6 after payrolls; 160 seen as the intervention trigger (tradingnews, Tradingpedia). Joint US-Japan intervention occurred in July (Wikipedia). Nov 9 level not found.
- **US:** October payrolls +165k, above expectations, wages +3.1%; 10y UST about 4.92% (headline-level, consensus and unemployment unverified). Brent below $100 (Saxo).
- **Bank of Korea:** base rate 3.00%, held in October (Korea Times); Citi and Morgan Stanley expect +25bp in November. Meeting Nov 26 KST (01:00 UTC) per investing.com versus Nov 25 on FXStreet: confirm. USD/KRW about 1,347 on Nov 9 versus 1,356.6 on Nov 6 (AJP).
- **Korea market structure:** authorities reportedly waived the 140% collateral ratio on securities-firm margin loans for three months from Nov 9 (source not captured; unverified). A sedaily piece flags Nov 11 as a focus date (not read).

Megacaps / tech (Japan)

- **SoftBank:** Section 1. **Sony (6758):** Nov 6 results were strong: FY forecast raised to ¥1.87tn from ¥1.72tn (likely operating income), buyback up to 16m shares; stock rose then faded (gamebiz, Yahoo JP). Close not found. MATTERS-positive fundamentals.
- **MegaChips (6875):** H1 listed Nov 6 on Investing.com; no results coverage found. FY forecast had been cut earlier this year. Highest-beta chip name; check TDnet.
- **Keyence, Canon, Daikin, Seiko Epson, Omron, Sanken, RS Technologies, Optex, Appier, Oro, SHIFT, Valqua:** nothing new found. Daikin and Epson raised on Nov 6 (see Nov 6 brief). Dates from prior runs: Omron Nov 10; Sanken Nov 11; Optex, RS Technologies, Appier Nov 13; Oro Nov 16. Chip/AI names likely rebounded Monday (inference). QUIET/UNVERIFIED.

Banks / financials / real estate

- **No stock-specific news found for any bank, Japan Post, SBI, Mitsui Fudosan or the real-estate/leisure names.** Dates (aggregator only): SMTG Nov 12; Kita-Nippon Nov 12 (15:00); MUFG Nov 13; 8524 Nov 13 (14:00); Japan Post Nov 13 (low confidence); Resona Nov 10–19 (uncertain). SMFG/Mizuho not held.
- **Identity check (8551 vs 8524):** J-LIC again lists 8524 as 北洋銀行 / Hokuyo Bank = The North Pacific Bank (Prime and Sapporo), and 8551 as The Kita-Nippon Bank. Still needs owner confirmation of which is held.
- Keisei, Fidea, Kyoto FG, Shimizu Bank, TOC, Yakult, Shochiku, Tokyotokeiba, Universal Entertainment, Katakura, JR Central: QUIET/UNVERIFIED.

Industrials / autos / small-mid caps

- **Suzuki (7269), Subaru (7270), Honda (7267), Kubota (6326), Nakayama Steel (5408), Ebara Jitsugyo (6328), Sumitomo Metal Mining (5713):** no actual H1/Q3 results found for any. Status unclear because dates conflict or may already have passed. Subaru: one source said Nov 6, another last year's Nov 10 (Q1 operating profit ¥42.6bn, -44%; FY guide ¥150bn; Car Watch). Honda: "mid-Nov," unconfirmed (Q1 record ¥530.8bn; FY guide raised to ¥650bn; Monoist). Suzuki Q1 operating profit ¥158.0bn (+11%; Suzuki). Kubota FY recurring guide ¥417bn (Monex);

Q3 may have been Nov 6–7. Nakayama (Nov 5 per kabuyoho vs Nov 10 per TradingView) and Ebara (Nov 5 per kabuyoho). Check TDnet for all.

- **Mitsubishi Materials (5711):** H1 Nov 11; FY recurring guide shown at ¥180bn vs ¥73bn in July, implying an upgrade (kabuyoho, no primary source; consensus ¥177.5bn). Candidate MATTERS.
- **JAPEX (1662):** H1 Nov 12, 14:00 (Traders Web).
- **Hi-Lex:** Q3 released Sep 4 (JPX); FY results mid-Dec. KH Neochem, Obara, Tigers Polymer (Nov 11), Shibaura Machine, Fudo Tetra: no information.

Korea names

- **LG Chem pref, NAVER:** Section 1. **LG Corp (003550):** read-through from LG Chem/LGES PRS (inference).
- **Taekwang Industrial (003240): MATTERS, unresolved.** Trustone (about 6.09%) demanded a higher dividend/split in July; Taekwang filed a police complaint against three Trustone people Sep 14; Trustone said it would sequence account-book inspection, derivative suit and EGM call after the Oct 3 reply deadline (Ajunews, Nate, Newstomato). No EGM call, filing or decision found after September; check DART.
- **Others (nothing found Nov 6–9):** Amorepacific, F&F, Hyosung, ILJIN, LG Electronics pref, LS Corp, Samsung C&T, SK Discovery, SK Inc, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss. QUIET/UNVERIFIED; chips rebounded and batteries/bio were weak on Nov 9 (affects SK Inc, LG-related names; inference). Q3 filing deadline Nov 14.

3. Probably noise

- **SoftBank ¥3,400 (-4.2%) close:** single unopened source, implausible level.
- **Trading Economics KOSPI about 5,132 (+1.43%):** stale snapshot.
- **CNBC Nov 8 dateline on the Nov 9 Nikkei close:** labeling issue only; arithmetic ties.
- **Nvidia/Huang probe:** headline risk, Asia shrugged it off.
- **Conflicting BoJ hike odds (54–80%):** unsourced snippets; use as a range.
- **Stale Korean price points (LS Corp ₩374,000 Jul 3; F&F about ₩69,000 Sep 19; Misto ₩39,200 Oct 7):** not current.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1) — matured Sun Nov 1; settlement still unverified. A JPX quotation sheet shows No. 466 as a **2-year, 0.500% note issued Nov 2024 maturing 2026/11/01**, consistent with earlier runs; the ISIN-to-bond mapping remains inferred. No MOF or custodian redemption evidence found. **Decisions:** (1) confirm with the custodian that proceeds settled (expected Mon Nov 2, now a week ago); (2) the reinvestment decision is overdue: 10y about 2.6–2.8%, 30y auction Nov 10, 5y auction Nov 12, BoJ December hike odds elevated; (3) update `watchlist-japan.md` once redemption is confirmed. The position is kept on the watchlist and flagged, not dropped.

Open identity question for owner: 8551 Kita-Nippon Bank vs 8524 North Pacific Bank (Hokuyo): still unresolved; coverage follows the ticker.

Portfolio-level: two-day drawdown of about 6% / 6% on Nov 6 only partly retraced in Japan and not at all in Korea. Review AI-linked concentration (SoftBank, SK Inc, Samsung C&T, RS Technologies, MegaChips, Sanken, Hyosung/LS) and margin/collateral mechanics ahead of SoftBank's print.

*Calendar (= aggregator/inferred/unconfirmed):**

- Nov 10: **SoftBank Group H1***; Omron; Honda*; Sumitomo Metal Mining*; JGB 30y auction*; Resona* (Nov 10–19)
- Nov 11: NAVER Q3 (16:00 KST)*; Sanken; Mitsubishi Materials; Tigers Polymer; "Nov 11 in focus" Korea item (unread)
- Nov 12: SMTG*; Kita-Nippon*; JAPEX (14:00); *JGB 5y auction*
- Nov 13: MUFG*; Japan Post*; 8524*; Appier; Optex; RS Technologies
- Nov 14: Korea Q3 filing deadline (ILJIN, F&F, LS and others)
- Nov 16: Oro Q3
- Nov 19: SK hynix buyback window ends (prior run)
- Nov 25/26: Bank of Korea meeting*
- Nov 27: LGES PRS settlement; NAVER new-share listing; Nov 27–Dec 24 LGES disposal window*; Dec 1 LG Chem buyback start*
- Dec 17/18: BoJ meeting*

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **SoftBank:** Does the Nov 10 print impair the ABB Robotics carrying value or mention termination terms? What are the CDS levels and OpenAI mark?
- **JGB 466:** Did the custodian settle the redemption? Where should proceeds go given the Nov 10 30y and Nov 12 5y auctions?
- **8551 vs 8524:** Which bank is actually held?
- **LG Chem / LGES:** Has the trust buyback started, and what is the common/preferred split? Confirm Q3 on DART.
- **Taekwang:** Has Trustone filed an EGM call or court action since Oct 3?
- **Subaru, Suzuki, Honda, Kubota, Nakayama, Ebara, SMM:** which have actually reported (TDnet Nov 5–9)?
- **MegaChips:** did the Nov 6 H1 print happen, and with what guidance?
- **BoJ:** December meeting date and sourced hike probability; actual policy rate.
- **Korea:** what is the Nov 11 focus date, and are the margin-loan collateral relaxations confirmed?